America: The Energy Superpower

Why the US is stronger on energy than most people realize — and why it matters

Jeffrey Cleveland · March 2026

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Note: This deck mixes oil-specific and broader energy metrics because US strategic and macro exposure run through both.

165 Years of Oil Prices — Today's Spike in Context

Crude oil in February 2026 dollars | 1861-1945 annual (Energy Institute), 1946-present monthly (EIA)

Sources: Energy Institute Statistical Review; EIA; BLS (CPI-U deflator)

Note: Pre-1946 data are annual midpoint observations; post-1946 are monthly averages | jeffreycleveland.com/presentations

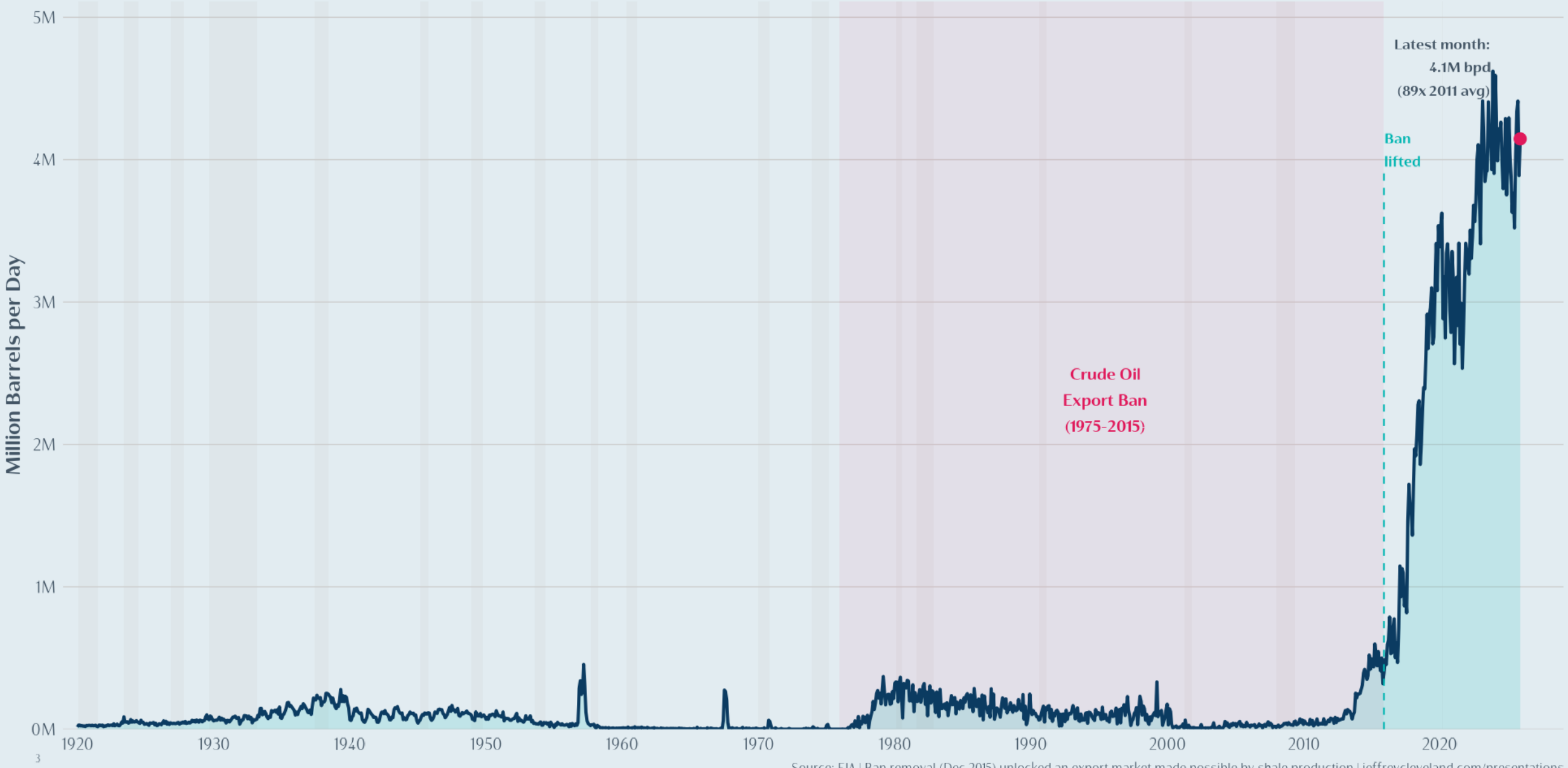
America the Energy Superpower: 105 Years of Crude Oil Production

US crude oil field production (million barrels per day) | Monthly peak 13.9M bpd (Oct 2025)

Source: EIA | jeffreycleveland.com/presentations

Shale Supply Unlocked a Global Export Market

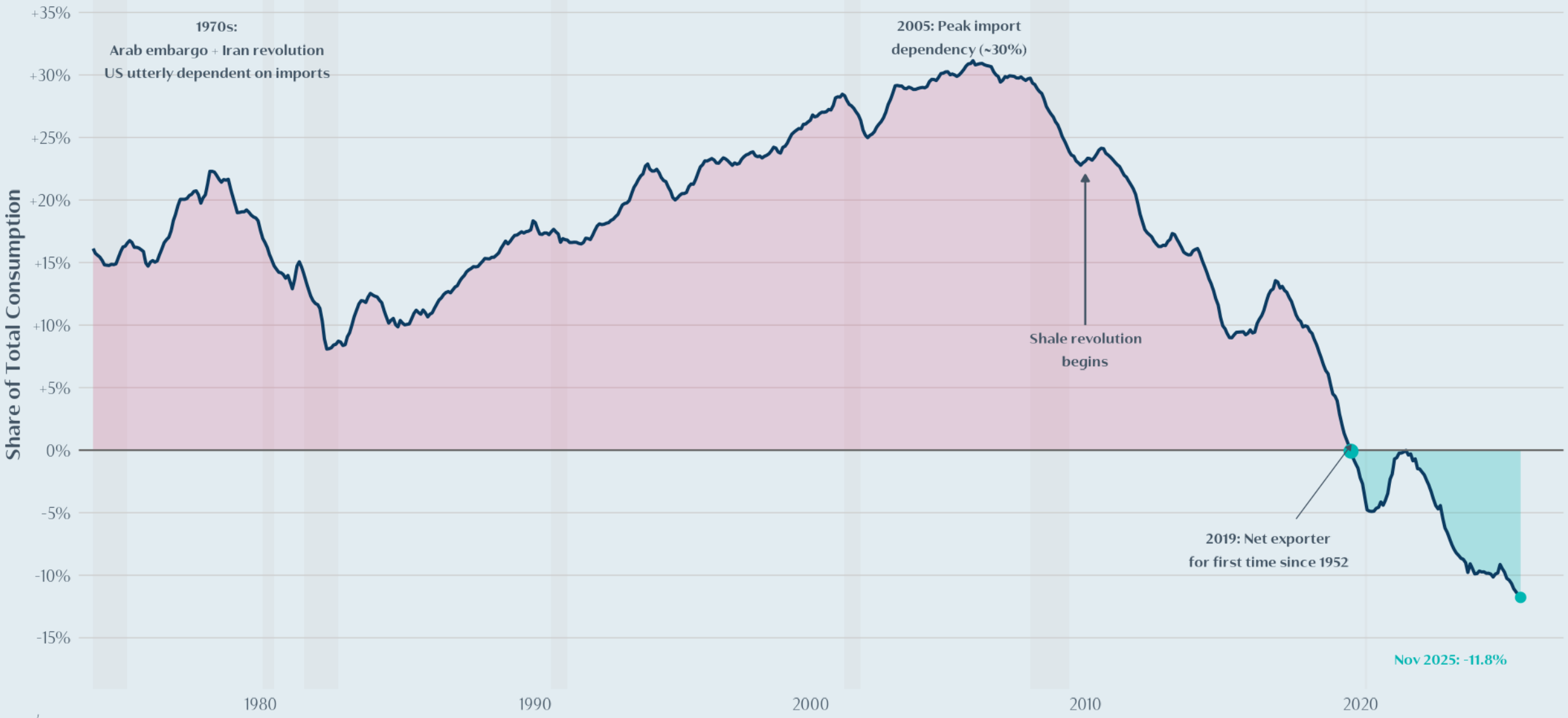
US crude oil exports (million barrels per day) | Export ban era shaded



Source: EIA | Ban removal (Dec 2015) unlocked an export market made possible by shale production | jeffreycleveland.com/presentations

Shale and Gas Ended the Net-Energy-Importer Era

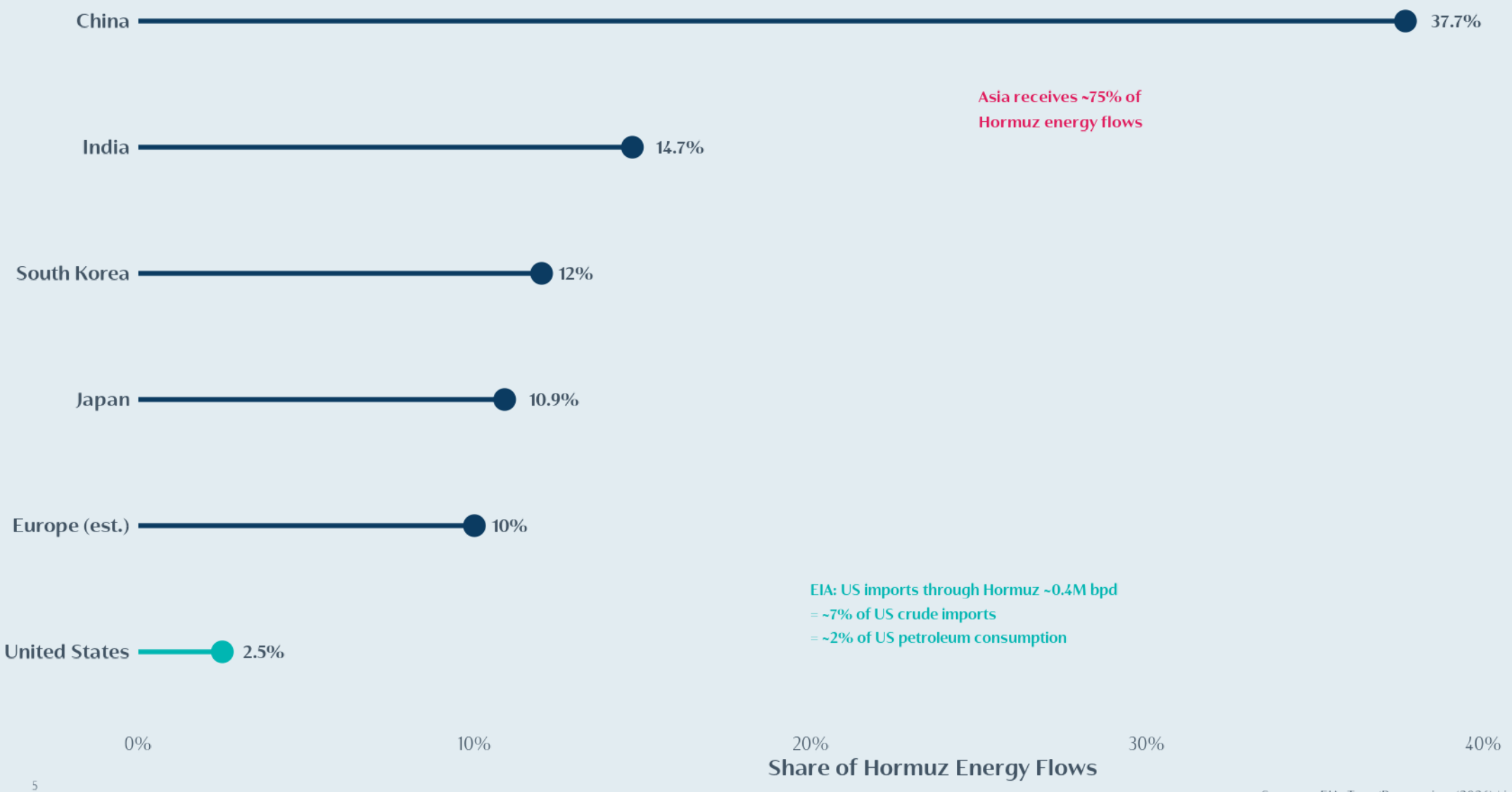
Net total energy imports as % of consumption (12-month moving avg) | Positive = net importer Negative = net exporter



Source: EIA | Note: Total energy includes oil, gas, coal, nuclear, renewables. US remains a net crude oil importer (~2.2M bpd, 2025) | jeffreycleveland.com/presentations

Who's Exposed? The Hormuz Asymmetry

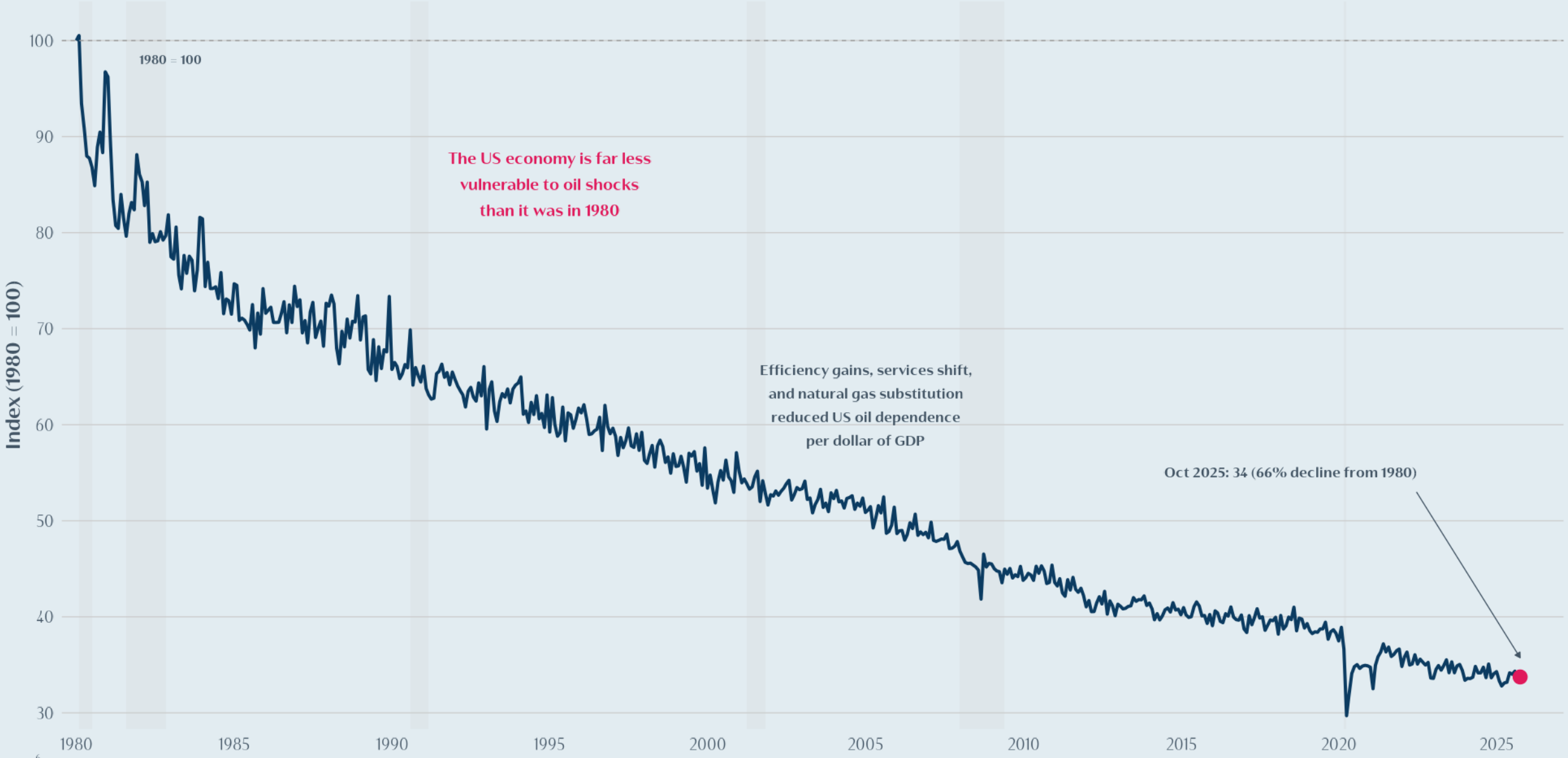
Share of Strait of Hormuz energy flows, by destination | US exposure vs. Asia & Europe



Sources: EIA; Toro/Persuasion (2026) | jeffreycleveland.com/presentations

The US Economy Became Far Less Oil-Intensive

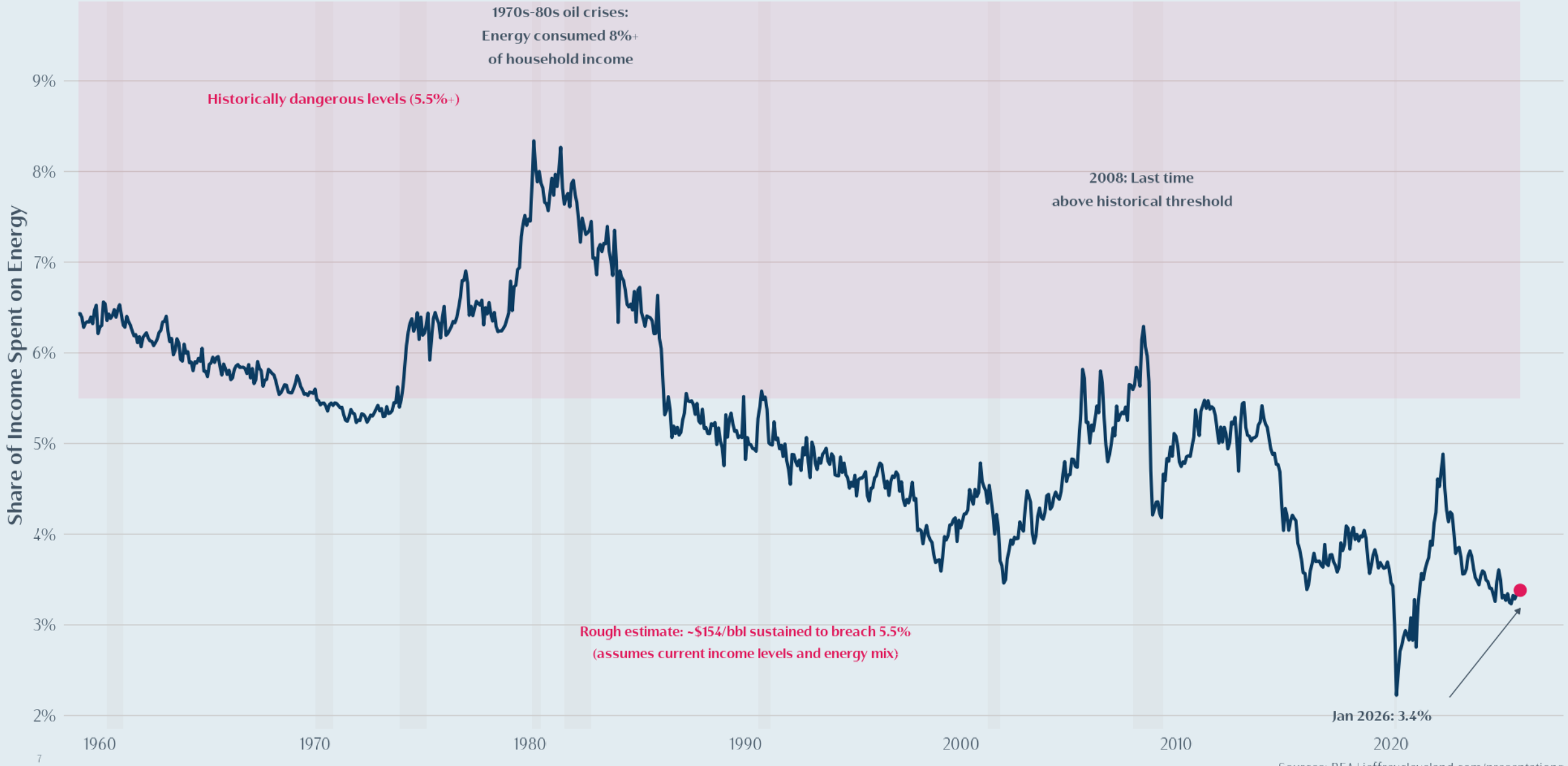
US oil consumption per unit of real GDP | Rebased: Jan.1980 = 100



Sources: EIA; BEA | Inspired by BCA Research | jeffreycleveland.com/presentations

The Energy Tax Is Well Below Historically Dangerous Levels

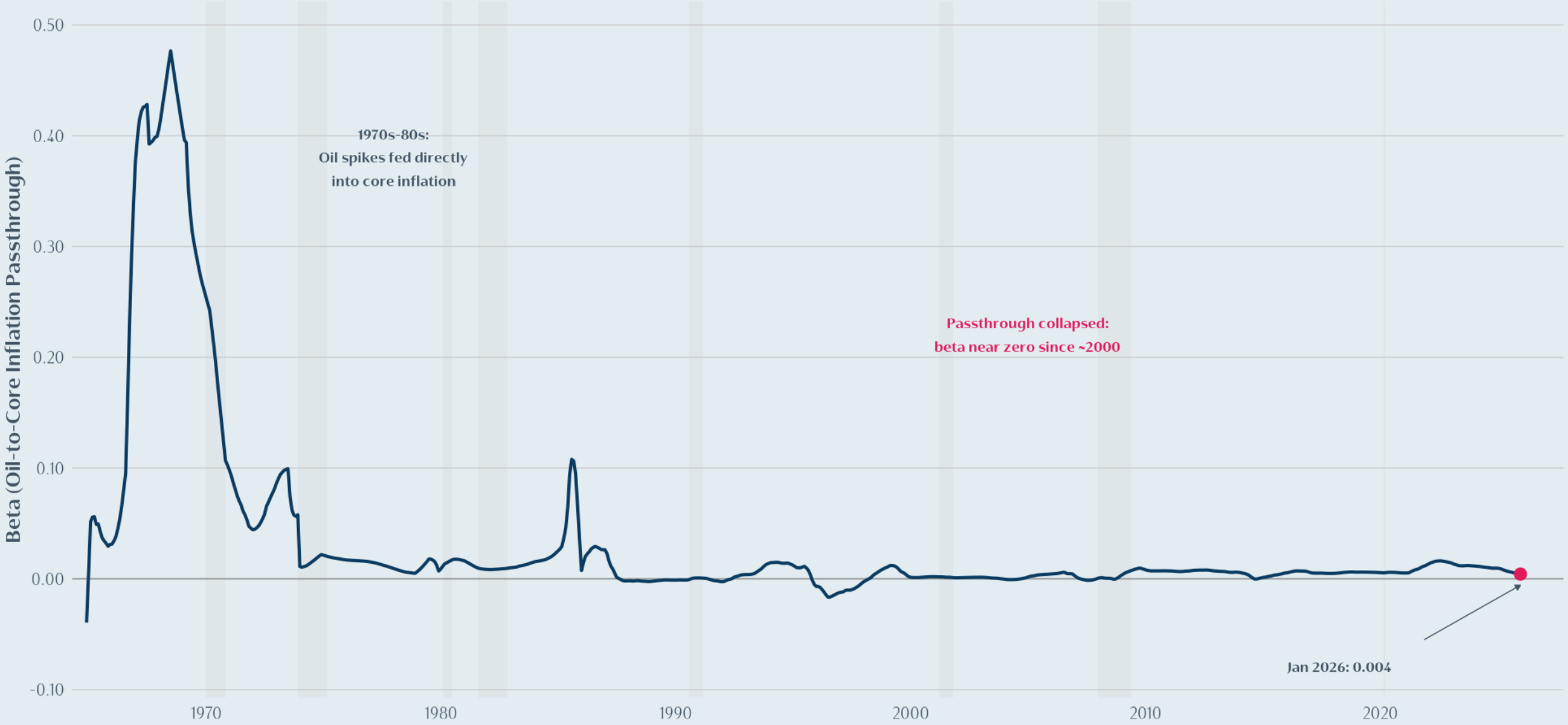
Energy spending as % of disposable personal income | Historically dangerous levels ~5.5%+



Sources: BEA | jeffreycleveland.com/presentations

Oil Is No Longer a Major Core-Inflation Channel

Rolling 60-month regression: Core PCE YoY% regressed on WTI YoY% | Higher beta = stronger passthrough



Sources: EIA; BEA | 60-month rolling OLS (reduced-form, not structural)

Beta = pp change in Core PCE for each 1pp change in WTI YoY | jeffreycleveland.com/presentations